LWTC
Lorenzo Walker Technical College

Meeting Minutes Page

Staff guide: record a meeting, build the minutes package, and add a transcript in Word.

stafftools.lwtc.app



Before you begin

The Meeting Minutes page records your meeting and packages the audio with the meeting details, ready to open in Word. This guide walks through each step, from opening the site to adding a transcript to your minutes.

A computer and a browser
Google Chrome is recommended. Microsoft Edge uses the same technology and should work the same way.

A microphone
The computer's built-in microphone, a headset, or a room microphone.

Microsoft Word
With your LWTC Microsoft 365 account. You need it to open the minutes and to add the transcript in Step 8.

About 10 minutes before the meeting
To fill in the details and test the microphone, so nothing surprises you once people are talking.

The process at a glance

1. **Open the site**
   Go to stafftools.lwtc.app and open Meeting minutes.
2. **Choose the meeting type**
   Fill in the details. The Occupational Advisory form has extra sections.
3. **Consent and microphone**
   Confirm everyone knows, allow Chrome to use the microphone, and run the check.
4. **Start and stop**
   Record, pause for breaks, and stop when the meeting ends.
5. **Download the package**
   One .zip file with the audio and your Word documents.
6. **Extract the files**
   Unzip the package into a folder.
7. **Open the minutes in Word**
   Click Enable Editing, then fill in anything left blank.
8. **Add the transcript**
   Use Word's Transcribe to turn the audio into text at the end of the document.

About the AI engine
The page has an optional "AI engine" sign-in that can draft minutes from the recording. It is not required, and it may not be connected yet. Everything in this guide works without it, so you can ignore that part of the page.

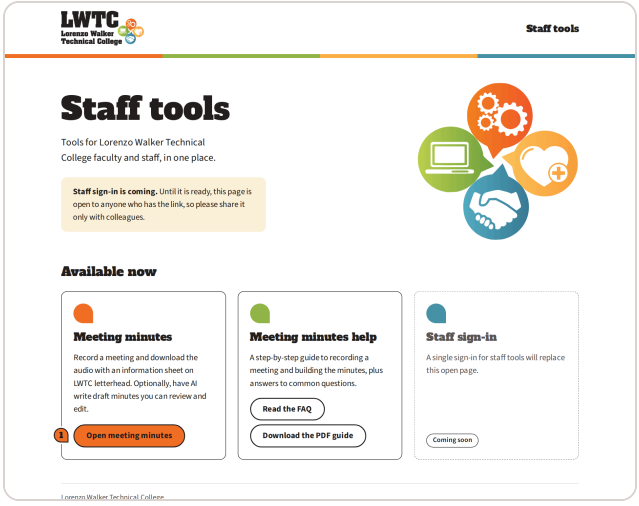
1 Open the site

From the Staff tools home page

1. Open **Google Chrome** on your computer.
2. In the address bar, type **https://stafftools.lwtc.app/** and press `Enter`.
3. On the Staff tools home page, find the **Meeting minutes** card and click **Open meeting minutes** (1).

Tip: bookmark it

Once the home page is open, press `Ctrl` + `D` (Windows) or `Cmd` + `D` (Mac) to save it to your bookmarks.



The Staff tools home page. Click **Open meeting minutes**.

Good to know

- **No sign-in is needed right now.** A staff sign-in page is coming. Until then the site is open to anyone who has the link, so share it only with colleagues.
- The **Meeting minutes help** card opens the FAQ and this PDF guide.
- On the meeting page, the **← Staff tools** link at the top returns you to the home page.

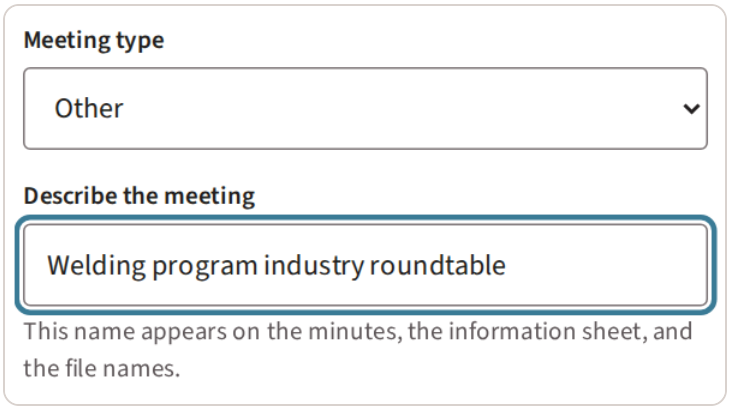
2 Choose the meeting type

The form is in the left column, under "1 Meeting details"

1. Open the **Meeting type** menu (1) and pick the one that fits: Advisory Board Meeting, Faculty Senate, Department Review, Curriculum Committee, **Occupational Advisory Meeting**, Accreditation Planning, Professional Development, or Other.
2. Fill in the **Date** and **Start time** (2), and the **Location or room**. Add **Expected attendees** if you like (optional).
3. Type your name under **Prepared by** (3).
4. Leave **Translated copy** (4) on "None" and leave the transcript checkbox unchecked. You will add the transcript in Word in Step 8.

If your meeting is not on the list

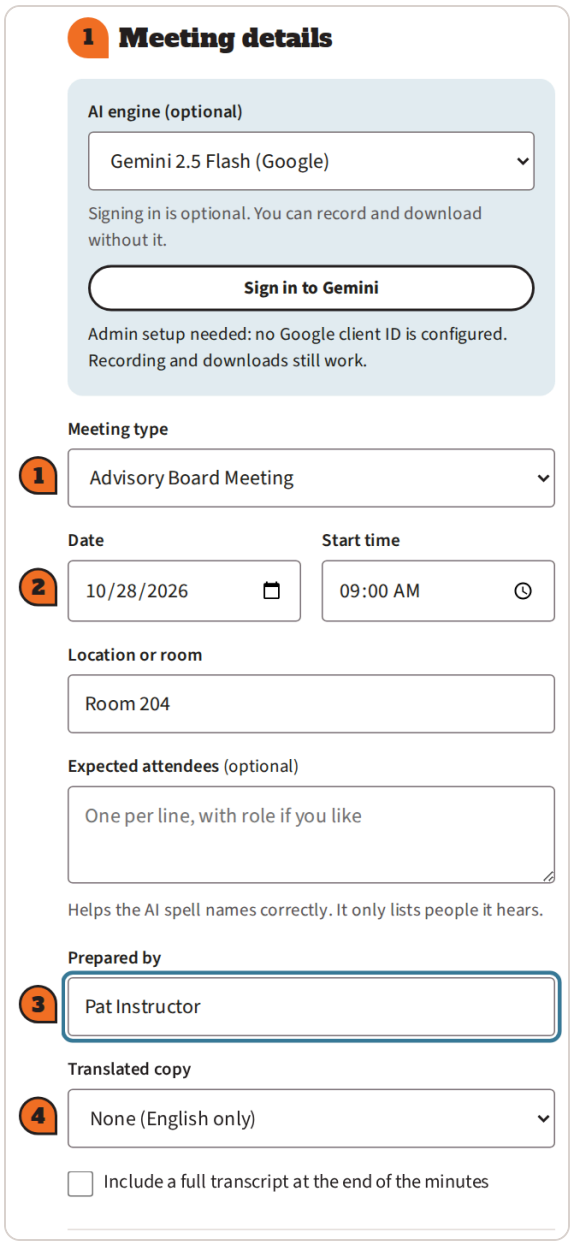
Choose **Other**. A box called **Describe the meeting** appears. Type a short name, such as "Welding program industry roundtable". That name is used in the Word documents and in the file names.



Choosing **Other** reveals the **Describe the meeting** box.

What the type changes

Every type gives you the audio and a meeting information sheet on LWTC letterhead. The **Occupational Advisory Meeting** type does more: it fills in the official OAC minutes template, as described next.



The **Meeting details** form: **1** meeting type, **2** date and start time, **3** prepared by, **4** translated copy.

2 The Occupational Advisory form

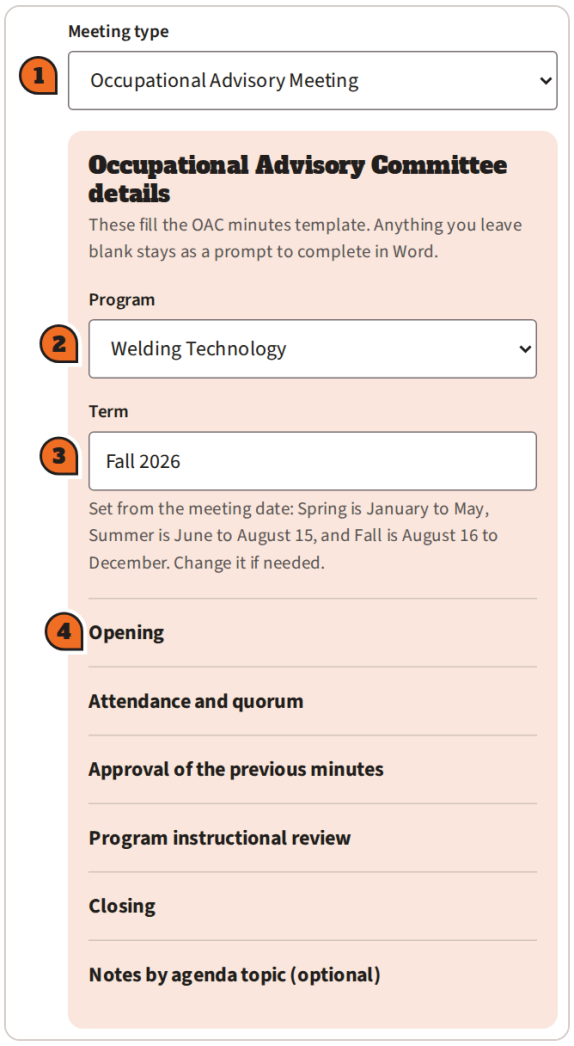
Part 1 of 3: choose the program and term

When you choose **Occupational Advisory Meeting** 1, an orange box called **Occupational Advisory Committee details** opens. It collects the same information as the Occupational Advisory Committee (OAC) Meeting Minutes template, and the page uses it to fill that template in for you.

1. Choose the **Program** 2 from the list. The program name is placed everywhere the template says "Program": at the top of the document and in the quorum, clock hours, delivery, work-based learning, curriculum, and assessment sentences.
2. Check the **Term** 3. It is set from the meeting date, and you can change it. Spring runs January to May, Summer runs June 1 to August 15, and Fall runs August 16 to December. The term also fills in the document title, the previous and next terms, and the academic year in the Program Status heading.
3. Open each section below the term by clicking its name 4, and fill in what you know. You do not need to complete everything.

Fill it in as you go, or afterward

You can type during the meeting, right after it, or not at all. Anything left blank stays in the Word document as a gray prompt ("Type minutes here" or "Choose an item") for you to complete there. The page never guesses.



1 Meeting type. **2** Program. **3** Term. **4** Click a section name to open it.

2 The Occupational Advisory form

Part 2 of 3: the sections, shown with sample information

Opening

Called to order at: 09:00 AM

Called to order by: Sample Instructor

Advisory members welcomed by: Sample Instructor

Opening. The time starts as your meeting start time. Change it to when you actually began.

Attendance and quorum

Advisory committee members present:

Sample Member One
Sample Member Two
Sample Member Three

Full names, one per line.

Advisory committee members absent:

Sample Member Four

Full names, one per line.

LWTC staff present:

Sample Dean
Sample Instructor

One per line.

Quorum present: Yes

Minimum of three members present. One can be virtual.

Attendance and quorum. One name per line. Three or more names sets the quorum to Yes.

Approval of the previous minutes

Motion made by: Sample Member One

Seconded by: Sample Member Two

Advisory committee members were: In favor: minutes approved

Approval of the previous minutes.

Program instructional review

Program clock hours: 1200

Delivery method: traditional

Classroom hours: 900

Lab/shop hours: 300

Work-based learning setting: paid Internship

Curriculum materials: digital books

Assessment: Industry Certification

Program instructional review. Choose from the menus or type the hours.

2 The Occupational Advisory form

Part 3 of 3: what goes where, and the minutes document

What goes in each section

Section	What to enter
Opening	The time called to order (it starts as your start time, so change it to the actual time), who called it to order, and who welcomed the advisory members.
Attendance and quorum	Members present, members absent, and LWTC staff present, with **one full name per line**. **Quorum present** becomes Yes once three or more members are listed (minimum of three; one can be virtual). Change it if needed.
Approval of the previous minutes	Who made the motion, who seconded, and whether members were in favor and the minutes approved.
Program instructional review	Clock hours, delivery method, classroom hours, lab/shop hours, work-based learning setting, curriculum materials, and assessment. Type hours as digits, such as 1200.
Closing	The time adjourned, the next meeting (it starts as the next term, "date TBD"), and who submitted the minutes (it starts as the name in Prepared by).
Notes by agenda topic	Optional notes for each topic, such as enrollment, completers, certifications, placement, accreditation, AI in the industry, and the open agenda.

Notes by agenda topic (optional)

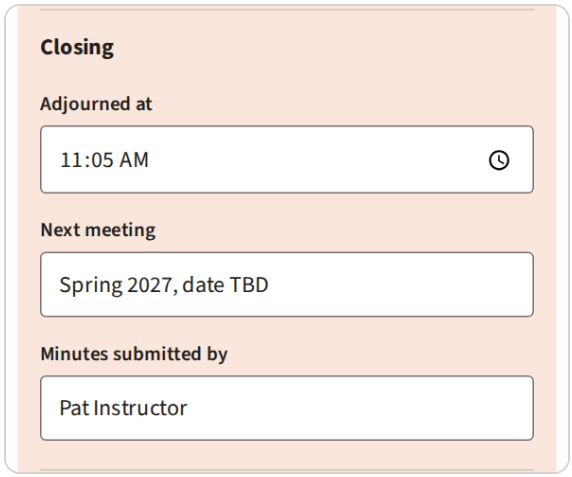
Click the section to open fifteen note boxes, one for each agenda topic. A note you leave blank stays as a "Type minutes here" prompt in Word.

Get the OAC minutes document

Click **Download OAC minutes (.docx)** in the Export section, or in the "Recording saved" panel. You can do this at any time, even without a recording, once a program is chosen. It is also included in the recording package (Step 5).

Check before you download

The documents use what is in the form at the moment you download. If you notice a mistake afterward, fix it in the form and download again, or correct it in Word.



Closing.

3 Consent and the microphone

Section "2 Record" in the left column

Confirm everyone knows

Tell everyone present that the meeting is being recorded, then check the box 1: **"Everyone present has been told this meeting is being recorded."** The page will not start recording until it is checked. Follow LWTC policy on recording meetings.

Allow Chrome to use the microphone

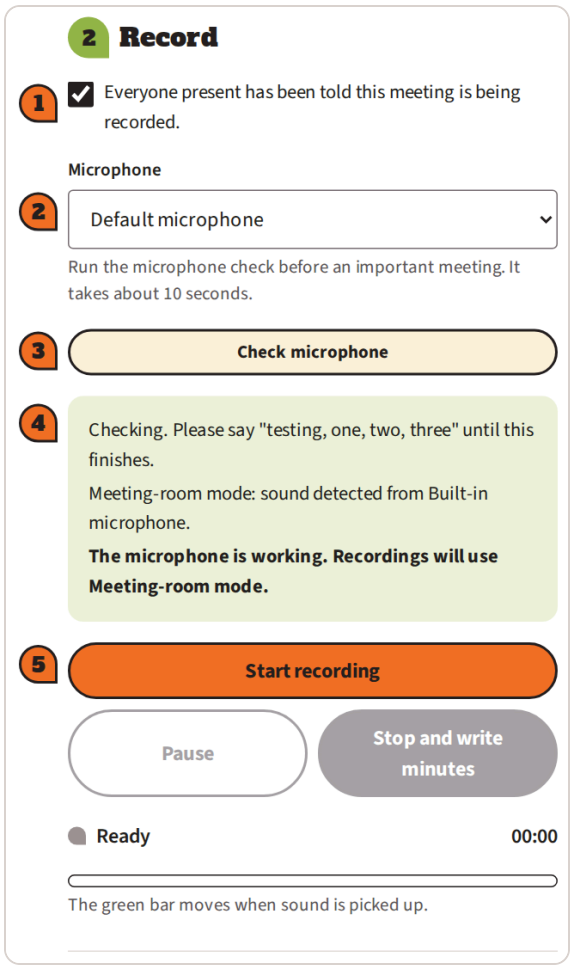
The first time you check the microphone or start recording, Chrome shows a small box near the address bar asking to use your microphone. Click **Allow** (choose "Allow while visiting the site" if you see it).

If you clicked Block, or no box appeared

1. Click the icon at the left end of the address bar (a lock or a settings-sliders icon) and open **Site settings**.
2. Set **Microphone** to **Allow**, then reload the page. (Or go to Chrome Settings → Privacy and security → Site settings → Microphone.)

Choose and test the microphone

1. **Pick the microphone** 2. "Default microphone" is usually right for a laptop or headset. In a conference room, choose the room microphone by name. The names appear once Chrome is allowed to use the microphone.
2. Click **Check microphone** 3 and say "testing, one, two, three" at the volume of a normal meeting. It takes about 10 seconds.
3. Read the result 4. **Green** ("The microphone is working") means you are ready. **Orange** means no sound was heard, and it lists what to check. It also tries your other microphones and picks one that works.



1 Consent box. **2** Microphone menu. **3** Check microphone. **4** The result. **5** Start recording. Your device name will differ.

Allowed, but still no sound?

Your computer may be blocking Chrome. **Windows:** Settings → Privacy & security → Microphone. Turn on microphone access and "Let desktop apps access your microphone." **Mac:** System Settings → Privacy & Security → Microphone, and turn on Google Chrome.

Do it before the meeting

Run the check when you arrive, not after everyone is seated.

4 Start and stop the recording

Still in the "2 Record" section

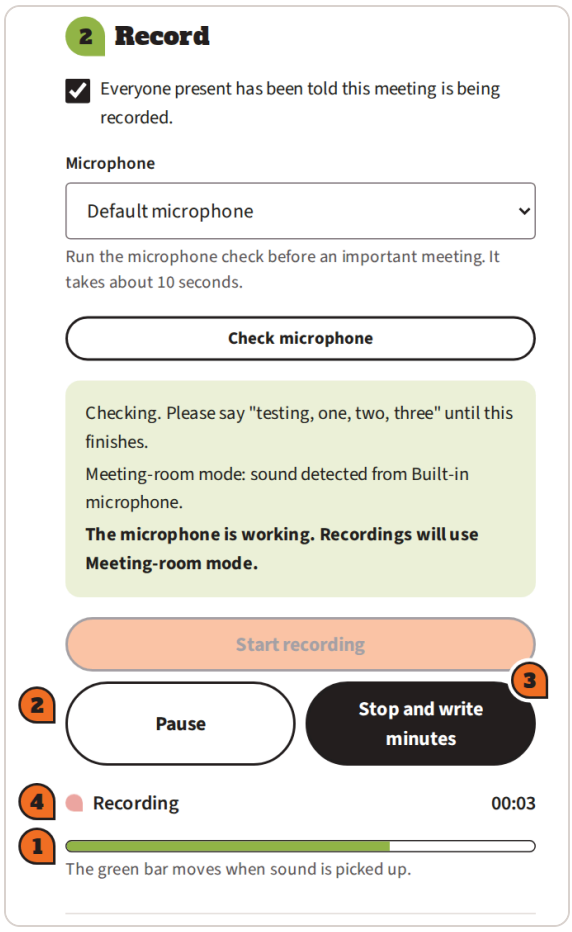
1. Click **Start recording**. The status changes to **Recording** and the timer starts 4.
2. Watch the **green level bar** 1. It moves when it picks up sound. If it stays flat for about eight seconds, a warning appears. Run the microphone check or choose a different microphone.
3. For a break, click **Pause** 2. Time while paused is not recorded. Click **Resume** to continue.
4. When the meeting ends, click **Stop and write minutes** 3. The status shows "Saving recording" and then "Recording saved." (The button always stops and saves the recording. It only writes minutes if the optional AI engine is connected.)
5. On the right, the **Recording saved** panel shows the length and a player. Press play 1 and listen for a few seconds to confirm the voices were captured.
6. Then click **Download recording package** 2 (Step 5).

Keep the page open until you have downloaded

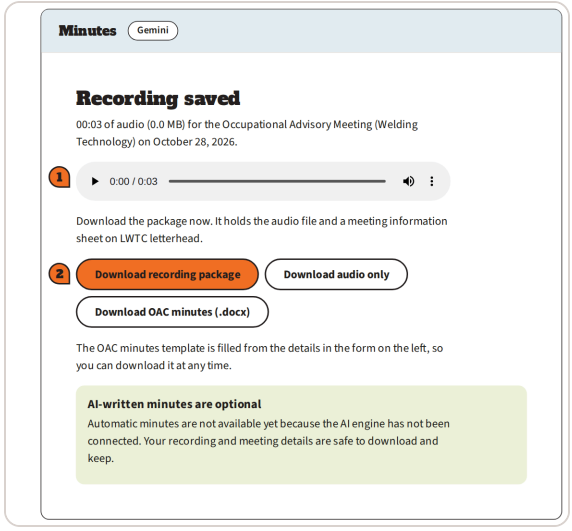
Your recording stays in the browser until you download it. Do not close or refresh the tab, and keep the computer awake (plugged in, with sleep turned off). The page warns you if you try to leave first.

If "This recording looks silent" appears

No sound reached the microphone. Click **Check microphone** in the warning, fix the problem, and record again. A silent recording cannot be recovered.



While recording: **1** level bar, **2** Pause, **3** Stop, **4** status and timer.



After you stop: **1** player, **2** download. The sample recording is three seconds long.

5 Download the recording package

One .zip file with everything from the meeting

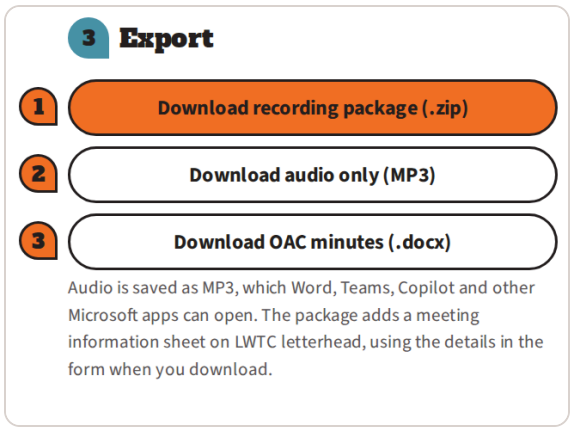
1. Click **Download recording package** in the "Recording saved" panel, or **Download recording package (.zip)** (1) in the Export section.
2. Chrome saves the file, normally in your **Downloads** folder. Click the download icon in Chrome's toolbar to see it, and choose **Show in folder** to find it.

The package is named from the meeting, for example `LWTC_OAC_welding-technology_2026-10-28_recording-package.zip`. Inside is:

recording-package.zip What you download

- **..._recording.mp3**
  The audio of the meeting.
- **..._meeting-info.docx**
  The meeting information sheet on LWTC letterhead.
- **..._OAC-minutes.docx**
  The filled-in OAC minutes. Occupational Advisory meetings only.

Why MP3?
MP3 is small (about 14 MB for an hour) and opens in Word, Teams, and other Microsoft apps, including Word's Transcribe in Step 8.



The **Export** section: **1** package, **2** audio only, **3** OAC minutes.

The other two buttons

Download audio only (MP3) (2) gives you just the recording.

Download OAC minutes (.docx) (3) gives you just the OAC minutes document. For other meeting types the button reads **Download minutes (.docx)** and works only after the AI engine has written minutes.

6 Extract the package

Unzip the files so you can open them

A .zip file is a folder squeezed into one file. Extract it before you use the files inside. Opening a file from inside the .zip can fail, and Word's audio upload needs the real MP3 file.

On Windows

1. Open **File Explorer** and go to **Downloads**.
2. Right-click the .zip file and choose **Extract All**.
3. Click **Extract**. A folder with the same name opens, with your files inside.

On a Mac

1. Open **Finder** and go to **Downloads**.
2. Double-click the .zip file.
3. A folder with the same name appears next to it, with your files inside.

What you should see

After extracting, the new folder holds the same files that were inside the package:

LWTC_OAC_welding-technology_2026-10-28_recording-package — The extracted folder

- **..._recording.mp3**
  The audio. You will upload this to Word in Step 8.
- **..._meeting-info.docx**
  The meeting information sheet.
- **..._OAC-minutes.docx**
  The OAC minutes. You will open this in Step 7.

Keep the files together

Move the extracted folder to where your department keeps meeting records. Keep the MP3 with the documents, and do not rename the files until you have finished the later steps.

7 Open the minutes and enable editing

Finish the document in Word

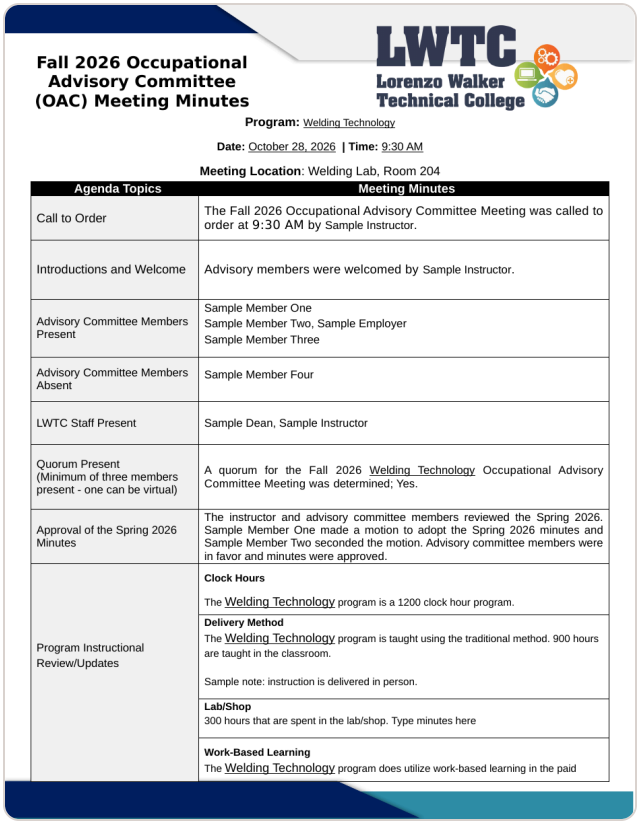
1. In the extracted folder, double-click `..._OAC-minutes.docx`. For other meeting types, open `..._meeting-info.docx`, or the minutes document you normally use.
2. Word opens the file in **Protected View**, with a yellow bar at the top. This happens to any file that came from the internet. Click **Enable Editing**. You cannot type until you do.
3. Read through the document. Everything you entered in the form is already in place.
4. **Gray prompts** such as "Type minutes here" are still blank. Click one and type. For a "Choose an item" prompt, click it and pick from the menu. Date and time prompts open a small picker.
5. Save the document: **File → Save As**, and choose a name and location.

The two documents

The **meeting information sheet** records the audio file, date, location, and who prepared it. The **OAC minutes** are the official template, with the LWTC header, the agenda table, and your program, term, and names filled in.

Review before you share

If the AI engine helped draft any of the text, check names, numbers, and decisions against your own notes first.



Fall 2026 Occupational Advisory Committee (OAC) Meeting Minutes

LWTC Lorenzo Walker Technical College

Program: Welding Technology

Date: October 28, 2026 | **Time:** 9:30 AM

Meeting Location: Welding Lab, Room 204

Agenda Topics	Meeting Minutes
Call to Order	The Fall 2026 Occupational Advisory Committee Meeting was called to order at 9:30 AM by Sample Instructor.
Introductions and Welcome	Advisory members were welcomed by Sample Instructor.
Advisory Committee Members Present	Sample Member One Sample Member Two, Sample Employer Sample Member Three
Advisory Committee Members Absent	Sample Member Four
LWTC Staff Present	Sample Dean, Sample Instructor
Quorum Present (Minimum of three members present - one can be virtual)	A quorum for the Fall 2026 Welding Technology Occupational Advisory Committee Meeting was determined; Yes.
Approval of the Spring 2026 Minutes	The instructor and advisory committee members reviewed the Spring 2026. Sample Member One made a motion to adopt the Spring 2026 minutes and Sample Member Two seconded the motion. Advisory committee members were in favor and minutes were approved.
Program Instructional Review/Updates	**Clock Hours** The Welding Technology program is a 1200 clock hour program.
	Delivery Method The Welding Technology program is taught using the traditional method. 900 hours are taught in the classroom. Sample note: instruction is delivered in person.
	Lab/Shop 300 hours that are spent in the lab/shop. Type minutes here
	Work-Based Learning The Welding Technology program does utilize work-based learning in the paid

A sample OAC minutes document (made-up information). Prompts you did not fill in stay for you to complete.

8 Add a transcript with Word

Use Word's built-in Transcribe to turn the audio into text

Word's **Transcribe** feature uploads the audio, turns the speech into text with a timestamp and a speaker label for each section, and lets you add that text to your document. It accepts MP3, WAV, M4A, and MP4 files, so the MP3 from this page works. You need to be signed in to Word with your Microsoft 365 account and connected to the internet.

1. Open the minutes document and make sure editing is enabled (Step 7).
2. Go to the **end of the document**. Press `Ctrl` + `End`, or click below the last table. Type a heading such as **Meeting Transcript** and press `Enter`.
3. On the **Home** tab, click the small arrow on the **Dictate** button and choose **Transcribe**. A pane opens on the right.

   Home › **Dictate ▾** › **Transcribe** › **Upload audio**

4. Check the language shown at the top of the pane (English for most meetings). Click **Upload audio** and choose the `..._recording.mp3` file from your extracted folder. Click **Open**.
5. **Wait for it to finish.** It can take up to about as long as the recording. Keep the Transcribe pane open. You can switch to other work and come back.
6. When it finishes, the pane lists the transcript in sections. Click a timestamp to hear that part. To rename a speaker, hover over a section, click the edit icon, type the name, and use the check box to change all of that speaker's sections at once. Confirm with the check mark.
7. Click **Add all to document**. (To add just one part, hover over a section and click **Add section to document**.) Check that the text landed under your Meeting Transcript heading. If it went somewhere else, cut and paste it into place.
8. Save the document.

Good to know

- The transcript is machine-written. Proofread names, numbers, and technical terms.
- Word keeps one transcript per document. A new transcription replaces the one in the pane, but text you already added stays.
- Microsoft sets a monthly limit on uploaded audio (300 minutes per month at the time of writing), so a one-hour meeting uses 60 of them.

Privacy

Word uploads the audio to your OneDrive, into a folder named **Transcribed Files**, and processes it in Microsoft's cloud. Delete the audio from that folder when you no longer need it, or when records policy says to.

If Transcribe is missing from the Dictate menu
Microsoft documents Transcribe for Word for Microsoft 365 on Windows with a work or school account. Make sure you are signed in with your LWTC account. If you still do not see it, or you are on a Mac, open the document in **Word for the web** (sign in at office.com, then open the file from OneDrive) and look under **Home › Dictate › Transcribe** there. If it is still not available, ask LWTC IT whether it is turned on for our Microsoft 365.

When something goes wrong

Problem	What to try
Start recording does nothing	Check the consent box, "Everyone present has been told this meeting is being recorded." A message appears at the bottom of the page if it is not checked.
Chrome says the microphone is blocked	Click the icon at the left of the address bar, open Site settings, set Microphone to Allow, then reload (Step 3).
The level bar does not move	Click Check microphone. Choose a different microphone in the Microphone menu. Check your computer's microphone privacy settings and close apps like Teams or Zoom that may be using it.
"This recording looks silent"	No sound was captured. Run Check microphone and record again. A silent recording cannot be recovered.
The program is missing from the list	Tell your administrator. The list is kept in the page, and a program can be added.
I closed the tab before downloading	The recording is lost, because it only exists in the browser until you download it. This is why the page warns you before you leave.
The download did not start	Click the download icon in Chrome's toolbar. Check that Chrome did not block multiple downloads, and click the button again.
I found a mistake after downloading	Fix the form and download again, or correct the text in Word. The documents use the form as it was when you clicked download.
Word will not let me type	Click Enable Editing in the yellow bar at the top (Step 7).
Word's Transcribe is missing	See the last box in Step 8: sign in with your LWTC account, try Word for the web, or ask IT.

Need more help?
Open the **Help and FAQ** link at the top of the Meeting Minutes page for more answers, or contact your program administrator or the LWTC IT help desk.

Quick checklist

Print this page or keep it open next to the meeting page.

Before

- [ ] Open stafftools.lwtc.app and choose Meeting minutes
- [ ] Choose the meeting type
- [ ] Fill in the date, time, and location
- [ ] For an Occupational Advisory meeting, choose the program and check the term
- [ ] Tell everyone the meeting is being recorded, and check the box
- [ ] Allow Chrome to use the microphone
- [ ] Choose the microphone and run Check microphone

During

- [ ] Click Start recording
- [ ] Confirm the green level bar moves when people talk
- [ ] Use Pause for breaks
- [ ] Keep the tab open and the computer awake
- [ ] Click Stop and write minutes at the end
- [ ] Play the preview to confirm there is sound

After

- [ ] Download the recording package
- [ ] Extract the .zip
- [ ] Open the minutes and click Enable Editing
- [ ] Fill in the gray prompts and check the details
- [ ] Add the transcript with Home › Dictate › Transcribe
- [ ] Proofread, then save
- [ ] Delete the audio from OneDrive's Transcribed Files folder if required